

5-73-117

CHAS. FIELD PHOTOGRAPHY

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accepted 12/9/73

## VERIFYING DOCUMENTATION OF AN UNUSUAL RECORD

1. Species: Least Bittern *Scoobyces exilis*? Number: 1  
 (Vernacular Name) (Scientific Name)

2. Location: 3445 Lake - 7 miles south of Pueblo, Colo

3. Date(s): May 22, 1973 Time Bird seen: am to 1 minute or longer

4. Description of size, shape and color pattern. (Describe in great detail all parts of the plumage including beak and feet coloration in addition to the diagnostic characteristics; however, include only what actually was seen in the field): A small bittern-shaped bird - light shoulder patches - somewhat flying - smaller than Green Heron - weak flight - only at a short distance

5. Description of voice, if heard: I can't remember now

6. Description of behavior: we flushed it from close to bare line - it flew away in a typical bittern heron fashion

7. Habitat - general: willow  
 specific: edge of shallow freshwater lake into stand - willow

8. Similarly appearing species which are eliminated 6, 7 and 8 above; Explain: Green Heron - larger and much different color -

9. Distance (how measured?):

10. Optical equipment: 7x35 binoculars

11. Light (sky, light on bird, position of sun in relation to bird and observer): clear, sunny - but was in overcast light

12. Previous experience with this species and similarly appearing species: none with Least Bittern - Green Heron I had seen several times

13. Did you think this species was unusual or rare? It was the first time it had been recorded in Pueblo area

14. Other observers: Jerry Ligon

15. Did others agree with your identification? yes

16. Other observers who independently identified this bird: Jerry Ligon; David Sebraman saw one same location a week later

17. Books, illustrations and advice consulted and how did these influence this documentation: Birds of North America - Golden Plover

Field Guide to the Birds of North America - 2nd Edition

18. If bird was photographed, please attach pictures and describe equipment used:

Dave Griffiths Street Address: 17 Solar Drive

Signature Date Prepared: May 26, 1973 City and State: Pueblo, Colorado

(USE THE REVERSE, OR ADDITIONAL PAGES, IF NECESSARY)